

Board 1

North Deals

None Vul

♠ Q 9 4
♥ J 9 8 5
♦ Q J 10 5
♣ J 10

♠ A J

♥ K Q 4 3

♦ A 7 3

♣ K 6 5 2

	N	
W		E
	S	

♠ K 10 7 2

♥ 10 6

♦ 9 8 2

♣ Q 9 4 3

♠ 8 6 5 3

♥ A 7 2

♦ K 6 4

♣ A 8 7

*West**North**East**South*

1NT

Pass

3NT

All Pass

3NT by North

Lead: ♠ 2

[showcards W:S2 N:S3]

The bidding has been as shown. Partner led the ♠ 2, dummy played the ♠ 3

Play the ♠ Q. This is a perfect example of why you should USUALLY play Third-hand-high.

If you do not put your ♠ Q on this trick declarer will get an undeserved winner with his ♠ J. In this Deal it will be his ninth trick. Play Third-hand-high and he will go down, otherwise he will make his contract.

Board 2

East Deals

N-S Vul

♠ K 10 7 4

♥ 10 4

♦ 9 5 3

♣ A Q J 3

♠ 2

♥ A 8 7 6 2

♦ K 8 4

♣ 10 8 5 2

	N	
W		E
	S	

♠ A Q J 8 6 3

♥ K 3

♦ Q 10 7

♣ K 6

♠ 9 5

♥ Q J 9 5

♦ A J 6 2

♣ 9 7 4

West

North

East

South

3 ♠

Pass

1 ♠

Pass

All Pass

4 ♠ by East

Lead: ♥Q

will pull trumps and discard two red losers on dummy's ♣ and make an overtrick.

[showcards W:HQ N:H4]

The bidding has been as shown. Partner led the ♥Q, dummy played the ♥4

Play the ♥A. You dare not play low for fear declarer might win a singleton ♥K.

And when you win the first trick, (the ♥K does NOT fall), you have to decide what to do next. Do not just return the suit like a robot since it is obvious that you have no more ♥ winners and you surely won't win any ♣ tricks.

You need to switch to a ♦, and the ♦4, (low from an honor) is recommended.

Played this way you will defeat the contract by one trick. If you allow declarer to win the first trick he

Board 3

South Deals

None Vul

♠ J 5 3
♥ Q 10 6
♦ K 6 2
♣ A 10 6 4

♠ K 9 8

♥ A 8 5

♦ Q J 9 4

♣ 9 7 3



♠ Q 7 4 2

♥ 9 7 4 3

♦ 8 7

♣ Q J 2

♠ A 10 6

♥ K J 2

♦ A 10 5 3

♣ K 8 5

West	North	East	South
Pass	3NT		1NT
All Pass			
3NT by South			
Lead: ♣4			

[showcards W:C4 N:C3]

The bidding has been as shown. Partner led the ♣4, dummy played the ♣3

Third-hand-high is usually a good plan to follow, certainly that is true in this deal. But that doesn't mean you should blindly play your HIGHEST card, rather you should play the LOWEST of high-equals.

In other words, in this case you should play the ♣J, which is equal to the ♣Q.

If instead you play the ♣Q, figuring it makes no difference, you'd be right that it makes no difference to you. But partner would then assume that it is declarer with the ♣J, and when he obtains the lead with the ♦K he will be unlikely to lead another ♣, which would be too bad for your side.

Board 4

West Deals

Both Vul

♠ A 9 5
 ♥ A K J 9 7 2
 ♦ 8
 ♣ 9 7 3

♠ Q 8 7 3

♥ 10 5

♦ A 5 4 2

♣ 8 4 2

	N	
W		E
	S	

♠ J 6 4

♥ Q 8

♦ K 9 7 3

♣ K Q J 10

♠ K 10 2

♥ 6 4 3

♦ Q J 10 6

♣ A 6 5

West	North	East	South
1 ♥	Pass	2 ♣	Pass
2 ♥	Pass	4 ♥	

All Pass

4 ♥ by West

Lead: ♠ 3

he can only make one ♠ trick when you play correctly.

[showcards W:S3 N:S4]

The bidding has been as shown. Partner led the ♠ 3, dummy played the ♠ 4

Play the ♠ 10.

Partner's low ♠ lead tells you that he has an honor in the suit. There are only two ♠ honors you can't see, and you know he wouldn't underlead an Ace at a suit contract. So partner holds the ♠ Q.

You can see clearly what would happen if you played Third-hand-high and put on your ♠ K. Declarer would win his ♠ A and could then set up a second ♠ trick by leading toward dummy's ♠ J.

By playing the ♠ 10 you force declarer to win with the ♠ A if he wants the trick. But however he plays

For your side, 2 ♠ tricks and the two minor Aces spell defeat.